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INFLUENCE OF REHABILITATION PROGRAMMES ON SOCIO-DEMOGRAPHIC CHARACTERISTICS OF RECIDIVISM IN ONDO STATE.

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Abstract

Rehabilitation programmes are designed to reform offenders, reduce recidivism, and prepare inmates for successful reintegration into society irrespective of the age and gender characteristic. It is a major concern that many inmate who passed through these programmes were re-incarnated, this study, therefore aim to investigate the rehabilitation services available in correctional centers and its influence on socio-demographic characteristics of inmates in Ondo State. The study investigated the influence of rehabilitation programmes on socio-demographic characteristics of recidivism in Ondo State. Two research questions and two hypotheses were raised to guide the study. The research adopted survey and it employs explanatory research method. The study used questionnaires and in-depth interview (idi) to elicit information from the recidivists and correctional personnel in the correctional centers. The sample consisted of 140 recidivists across the five correctional centers in the three senatorial district of Ondo State. The correctional institutions (prisons) include the medium security prisons at Akure-Olokuta, Segede ondo, Surulere Ondo, Okitipupa and Owo. The population of the study comprised all the recidivists in the five correctional centers of Ondo State. 140 respondents were purposively selected from Ondo State, Nigeria. Finding revealed that skills acquisition programmes were available in correctional centers with the highest mean value of 4.45. The finding revealed that rehabilitation programmes had no influence on recidivists in Ondo State. The finding further revealed there was no significant difference between male and female recidivist in the rehabilitation programme (t-cal of 0.569 < 0.05 level of significance). Age had no influence on rehabilitation programme among recidivists [$F_{3, 136} = 0.415 > 0.05$]. It was concluded that rehabilitation programmes including skill acquisition, educational services, recreational activities and social interventional services were observed in the correctional centers but had no influence on inmates in Ondo State. Based on the aforementioned findings, recommendations are made that correctional centers should be sufficiently funded by the government to boost effective rehabilitation of inmates. Additional skills acquisition programmes such as computer trainings, auto-mechanics, photography, barbing and hair-dressing are established to boost inmates' employment opportunities on discharge from the prisons.

Keyword: Rehabilitation Services, Age, Gender, Recidivists, Correctional Centers

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Introduction

Rehabilitation programs seem to play a significant role in influencing recidivism rates by transforming offenders into law-abiding citizens and reduce the social, economic, and personal costs of crime. It seems to create a more effective, humane, and sustainable criminal justice system among offenders. Despite the significant influence of rehabilitation programs in the correctional centres, it appears that many correctional centres witness increased in the number of inmates admitted for one offence or the others and re-incarnated again for another or similar offence. It is expected that when criminals are caught and prosecuted, they will be sent to correctional centres for reformation, rehabilitation and transformation while serving a jail term before re-integrate or re-socialize back to the society. It was observed that many of these criminals were re-incarnated back to the society despite lots of rehabilitation programmes put in place by the custodians of correctional centres in an attempt to refine the criminals to better persons (Abrifor, Popoola & Essien 2023). It is worrisome and a concern to the researcher and major stakeholders on the number of criminals who were re-incarnated (recidivists) for another various offences or similar one.

Recidivism is the relapse into criminal activity and is generally measured by a former prisoner's return to prison for a new offence or similar offence. The rate of recidivism in Nigeria is estimated to be about one thirds, which means that one thirds of released inmates will be re-incarcerated after their release from prisons (Idowu & Odivwri, 2019). As a result of this, crime by former inmates alone account for a substantial share of the current and future crimes. From the trend in the high prevalence of recidivism in Nigeria, there is a staggering high number of people being incarcerated and eventually released back to the community and the high risk of re-arrest and re-incarceration is a concern for policymakers, criminologists, and those involved in corrections

Recidivism simply refers to the act of committing more crime after an offender had been previously corrected through arrested by the police (or other law enforcement agents in the society), tried and convicted in the law court, punished by sentencing to prison, rehabilitated and re-integrated into the society (Wang'ombe, 2019). Recidivists are more prone to committing crimes as the earlier punishment does not have the expected positive effect on him/her again. With this increase in crime rate as many were re-incarnated back to the correctional centres, majority of the correctional centres in Nigeria seem congested and overcrowded and creating enormous problem in prison management process and probably costing government a huge amount of money for proper maintenance.

In Nigeria for example, it appears there is still no influence of rehabilitation programmes on socio-demographic characteristic of inmates including their age, gender, religious, and tribe as many inmates were re-incarnated to the correctional environment. It was observed by Awopetu, 2014 that the rate of incarceration has increased dramatically where prisons are filled to capacity with an alarming overcrowding that leads to bad environments for the offenders. Crime continues inside the prison walls and gangs are rife behind bars (Awopetu, 2014). It is believed that these sets of individuals must have pass through series of program during their jail terms geared towards reform, refine inmates back to the society.

According Ochorma, Chijioke and Nwoodo (2020) rehabilitation services are initiated in the correctional centre to help criminals tap to their potential or improve skills and functioning for daily living that would help them to be self – independent and do away with criminal acts. These services which

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may include, skill acquisitions programme, counselling programme, career talk, adult literacy and carpentry, tailoring, arts/crafts and welding, Soap making building trades, motor mechanics, fitting and turning, carpentry and upholstery, manufacturing of furniture and clothing to computer training and religious programme are operated to put the criminals and society on a safe and secure prisons and provide effective community supervision in order to enhance public safety. Rehabilitative Services is committed to this mission and understands that the best way to protect the public is by providing effective, evidenced-based programming that inculcates fundamental skills in individuals under the supervision of skill officers so that they can lead independent, productive and successful lives (Ogunmefun, Adefuye & Adekunle, 2024). The Nigerian Correctional Service, formerly known as Nigerian Prison Service is a government agency of Nigeria which operates the management of prisons. The agency is saddled with the responsibility of reformation, rehabilitation and reintegration of convicted individual to the society. However, Nigeria government has not relented in curbing and preventing crime related issues by the establishment of security agencies with their statutory duties to combat and manage crime related matters of any kind and place sanction on any offenders as stipulated in penal code practiced in the Northern and criminal code in the Southern part of the country.

The available data on recidivism in Nigeria is an indication that the ex-offenders that are released by the correctional centers are not rehabilitated (Freeman, 2003). More optimism about the effectiveness of correctional programmes and the likelihood of them preventing reoffending. A jail is a facility built to incarcerate offenders before or after the trial. The rate at which released offenders' relapse to crime and prison is alarming in Nigeria. Findings from the National Bureau of Statistics (2016) revealed that, an average of 31.3% of the released offenders from the Nigerian Prisons between 2007 and 2014 go back to crime and prison again few years after their previous release. Atere and Akinwale (2018) reported in a study that the prevalence rate of recidivism in Nigeria in 2005 was 37.3%. Furthermore, Abrifor, Atere and Muoghalu (2012) estimated the rise in prevalence of recidivism in Nigerian prisons at 52.4% in 2010. Since then, there has not been any indication that the trend has declined. The known fact here is that there is increasing waves of recidivism in Nigeria for some time now till date. Recidivism is a global social problem and Nigeria in particular. It affects the society directly and/or indirectly. Globally, the actual rate of recidivism is not accurately known, as it depends on the panel system of every country of the world and other several contextual and relative factors. The concept of recidivism is relativism in nature.

Scholars seem to pay little attention to the socio-demographic factors of gender, age and crime until the 1960s. However, this issue began to gain attention as a result of the political and social changes of the women's movement, as well as the civil rights movement. In recent times, women activities begin to gain attention following emergence of current trend of women involvement in some deviant behaviour. Prior to that, it was usually agreed upon that men engaging in crime was the norm and common societal attribute related to them, and women who engaged in crime were seen as anomalies. In the 21st century, scholars often focus on adults who fall within the age of 20 to 40 years to be more active and energetic to commit crime in the society. Personal observation by the researcher has revealed that crime is committed by all age group even the minor in the contemporary society.

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Personal observation by the researcher revealed that in Nigeria for example, the rate at which released inmates return into the prisons (recidivation) few months or years after release have attracted the attention and interest of many stakeholders and criminologists across the globe. Recidivism is now a common phenomenon among inmates in the Nigerian prisons. Gender is not left out when talking about recidivists in correctional centres all over the world. These include both the male and female recidivists in the Nigerian prisons. According to (NCS, 2022) the various crime committed in Nigeria include: Murder, Non-negligent manslaughter, Negligent manslaughter, Killing of unborn child, Abduction, Armed robbery, Kidnapping, Rape/Sexual assault, Robbery, Assault, Threatening of life, Burglary, Fraud/Forgery and Altering, Motor vehicle theft, Stealing, Obtaining by pretence (419), Impersonation, Unlawful Possession of Fire Arms, Possession of illicit drug, Trafficking of drugs, Affray, Escape from lawful custody, Public fighting, Secret Cult/Society (Cultism), Unlawful breaking and entry, False Statement, ritual killing, and many more.

The high prevalence of recidivism has implications for social, economic growth and development in Nigeria. Recidivism contributes to high crime rates which have resulted in loss of lives and properties thereby threatening peace, safety of lives and national cohesion in Nigeria (Abrifor, et al., 2012). Besides, high rate of recidivism is a threat to good governance in the country. Crime always brings down a nation. Nigeria has had its fair share. It appears that the increased crime rate has pose an adverse effect on sustainable economic growth in Nigeria which has the tendency in driving away both foreign and domestic investors, low investment eventually increase unemployment and poverty. We cannot underestimate the level of damage crime has caused us internationally and the futuristic effect on the Nigerian society. According to Crime Index by country, Nigeria rank 16th position in the global crime index, this position has put Nigeria among the leading country in term of crime and criminality in the world. The most profound consequence of crime is the loss of human life. The spate of insecurity in Nigeria drawn grave concerns from the citizens and the international communities, especially over investment and business transaction. Report has indicated that Nigeria Government loose huge amount of money on yearly bases to fight crime. In 2020 Budget: National Assembly unanimously approves capital expenditure on yearly basis in the fight of crime and criminalities. Increase in crime rates have affected Nigeria's attempt to develop a viable tourism industry as visitors are regularly warned by their countries to be wary of coming to Nigeria. Many would-be investors have also stayed away for fears of being kidnapped (Inyang & Ubong, 2013). It is no longer news that the once respected nation, Nigeria, went down in the "black book" of most foreign nations especially America as a terrorist ridden nation. Government needs to maintain effective rehabilitation of the offenders by reforming the prison system through re-orientation and quality service delivery. The reintegration of ex-offenders into the community has emerged as a key concern of the criminal justice system as prison populations have increased globally. High recidivism rates indicate that prisons have not adequately prepared many prisoners for life after prisons. This study therefore investigates influence of rehabilitation programmes on socio-demographic characteristics of recidivism in Ondo State.

Statement of the Problem

It is assumed that effective rehabilitation and reformation that are coupled with proper community reintegration could prove pivotal in reducing the ever-increasing rate of recidivism in the society. Unfortunately, it seems that the rehabilitation pro-

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grammes available in the correctional centers do not successfully rehabilitate most inmates, and the majority of criminals return to a life of crime almost immediately. Many argue that most prisoners will actually learn new and better ways to commit crimes while they are locked up with their fellow convicts. They can also make connections and become more deeply involved in the criminal world. It is expected that effective rehabilitation and reformation of prisoners depend largely influence a better outcome that would in turn refine the inmates from further committing crime. If this this trend continues, the country may stand the risk of undeveloped, culminations of criminal elements,

Prison officers play important roles in the proper functioning of correctional institutions and directly impact on the behaviours of inmates through their daily contacts with them (Moon & Maxwell, 2004). It is expected that rehabilitation programs should play a significant role on the life of offenders before re-socialized back to the society so that they can be useful to the self and the community at large.

Research Questions

1. What are the common rehabilitation services available in correctional centers in Ondo State?
2. To what extent does rehabilitation programme influence socio-demographic characteristics of recidivists in Ondo State.?

Research Hypotheses

1. There is no significant difference in the mean score of male and female recidivists on the influence of rehabilitation programme in Ondo State
2. There is no significant difference in the mean score of recidivists on the influence of rehabilitation programme on the basis of age in Ondo State.

Literature Review

Within the coverage of correctional studies, there are numerous theories that can be used to explaining the influence of rehabilitation programmes on socio-demographic characteristics of recidivism in Ondo State. Rehabilitation theory is a concept in criminology and penology that emphasizes reforming offenders rather than merely punishing them. It is based on the belief that criminal behaviour is caused by internal or external factors that can be treated, corrected, or managed through structured intervention. The goal is to help offenders change their behaviour so they can reintegrate into society as law-abiding citizens. Rehabilitation programmes are crucial components of modern prison systems. They aim to reform inmates, reduce repeat offenses, and promote safer societies. Within the prison yard, these programmes offer both practical benefits and long-term solutions to criminal behaviour. Rehabilitation programmes in the prison yard are not optional—they are essential. They transform prisons from warehouses of punishment into centers of correction and growth. By equipping inmates with skills, healing, and hope, these programmes protect society and give individuals a real chance at a better life.

The researcher adopted rehabilitation theory coined by Howard, Becker and Blanche Geer (1957) are sociologists best known for their work on labeling theory and studies of deviance, rather than explicitly formulating a "rehabilitation theory" in the traditional sense used in correctional psychology. One of the primary goals of rehabilitation is to prevent

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reoffending. Inmates who participate in structured programmes—such as vocational training, education or substance abuse treatment—are less likely to return to crime. Studies have shown that such programmes significantly reduce the rate of recidivism However, their research and insights directly influenced modern rehabilitation thinking, especially in how society's treatment of offenders affects their behavior and identity. Core Assumptions of Rehabilitation Theory: Crime is a symptom of underlying problems (e.g., poverty, trauma, addiction, lack of education). Offenders can change if given the right support, tools, and environment like vocational, educational, recreational programme, Punishment alone does not prevent crime—but rehabilitation can reduce the likelihood of reoffending. Correctional institutions have a moral and social responsibility to reform rather than simply detain.

Howard Becker and Blanche Geer did not create a formal "rehabilitation theory" but contributed foundational ideas through: Labeling Theory (Becker). The theory emphasizes how being labeled a criminal influences future behaviour. Institutional Sociology (Becker & Geer): How environments shape identity and behaviour. The look into how rehabilitation programs affect recidivism (re-offending) and specifically looking at how this impact varies across different socio-demographic characteristics (e.g., age, gender, education, income, ethnicity, employment status, etc.). Their work underlines the importance of how society treats offenders, both inside and outside prison, in determining whether rehabilitation is possible.

In the content of Nigeria system, the theory of rehabilitation is particularly important while considering the challenges and consequences of recidivism with the correctional centers in Nigeria (Ogunmefun, Aborisade &Atere, 2024). As opined by Ogunmefun and Aiyuwuse (2023) the major challenges faced by correctional centers are lack of adequate transformational programmes, leading to prison congestion. Akers and Jennings (2019) emphasize the need for rehabilitation programmes that are sensitive in term of culture, considering the diversification of Nigeria culture. The theory is applicable to the correctional center in Nigeria. The theory suggests that if inmates are expose to transformational programmes, it will have positive impact on the decongestion on the number of inmates admitted to the correctional centers.

Some of the strength of rehabilitation theory by Howard, Becker and Blanche Geer (1957) was emphasizes laid on an important foundation for rehabilitation-based correctional programmes. Their contributions help explain why and how rehabilitation efforts can succeed if applied within the correct social context. Offenders can learn positive behaviour by modeling it. People have the capacity for growth and change. The theory helps explain how individuals can move away from deviant roles if they are not constantly reminded, exposed to training or trapped by their past identity. Although Howard Becker and Blanche Geer contributed greatly to criminal thinking about deviance and rehabilitation—especially through theory—their approach.

Despite the strength of the theory, it is without limitations. These weaknesses affect how effectively their ideas can be applied to correctional systems and rehabilitation efforts. The theory focuses heavily on society's role in preventing deviance based on the available programmes, often downplaying the individual's responsibility for their actions. This can lead to the mistaken belief that offenders are only victims of societal labels, which may undermine efforts to encourage personal accountability

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and behavioral change**.** It provides little concrete guidance on how to design or implement effective rehabilitation strategies inside prisons (e.g., therapy methods, vocational models). The theory often ignores personal responsibility, psychological roots of crime, and the complexity of individual behaviour. It lacks practical, actionable tools for rehabilitation in correctional institutions. It provides limited guidance on how to combat deeply ingrained social stigma in real-world settings. To be truly effective, rehabilitation approaches must combine sociological insights from Becker and Geer with psychological, behavioral, and systemic interventions

Methodology

This study adopted both quantitative and qualitative methods of research. The research adopted survey and it employs explanatory research method. It used questionnaires and In-depth Interview (IDI) to elicit information from the recidivists and correctional personnel in the correctional centres. The correctional institutions (prisons) include the medium security prisons at Akure-Olokuta, Segede Ondo, Surulere Ondo, Okitipupa and Owo. The explanatory study sourced first-hand-information from the field. The research design is descriptive in nature. Respondents numbering 140 were sampled to involve in the study; however, the study involved 140 respondents were purposively from thee five correctional centres in Ondo State. The questionnaires were administered among the recidivists and in-depth interview was conducted among the correctional personnel, community leaders and some selected recidivists. The quantitative data collected through questionnaires were sorted, organized, cleaned, coded, computed and processed with the aid of Statistical Package for Social Scientists (SPSS) version 21.0 as tool of analysis to process the data. Descriptive statistics was employed to summarize and interpret the data; while the hypotheses were tested with inferential statistics to identify the relationships and/or associations between the variables. The research assistants and respondents were thoroughly intimidated with the purpose of the study. The questionnaire was distributed to the respondents by hand and retrieved immediately after the completion for the purpose of data analysis.

Results:

Research Question

1: What are the common rehabilitation services available in correctional centers in Ondo State?

In answering the research question, responses of the respondents were collated, scored and subjected to analysis to descriptive statistic and the result is presented in Table 1

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Table 1: Common rehabilitation services available in the correctional services

	Rehabilitation services	N	Agree Freq (%)	Disagree Freq(%)	Mean
1	Skills acquisition programmes were available in correctional centers	140	88 (62.9%)	52 (37.1%)	4.45
2	Educational Services were availability for inmates in correctional centers	140	59 (42.1%)	81 (57.9%)	3.78
3	Recreational Activities were available for inmate in correctional centers	140	44 (31.4%)	96 (68.6%)	4.01
4	Social Intervention Services were available for inmate in correctional centers	140	71 (50.7%)	69 (49.3%)	4.31

Field survey, 2024

Table 1 showed that 88 (58%) respondents agreed that skills acquisition programmes including tailoring, carpentry, farming and craft/art activities were part of rehabilitation programme in the correctional centers while 52 (42%) respondents disagreed. 59 (44%) respondents indicated that educational programmes including adult and literate education programmes, reading and writing capacity were part of rehabilitation programmes in the centers while 81 (56%) disagreed. 44 (29%) respondents indicated that recreational activities including football activity, table tennis, indoor games such as ludo, cards and draft, basketball and volleyball games were part of rehabilitation programme while 96 (71%) disagreed. 71 (51%) respondents agreed that social intervention services including social advocacy, behaviour and build on their strengths to cope on release is offered, care services are offered to ensure recidivists reformation were part of rehabilitation programme while 69 (49%) disagreed.

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Research Question 2: To what extent does rehabilitation programme influence recidivists in Ondo State.?

Table 2: Influence of rehabilitation programme on of recidivists

S/N	Items	N	Agreed Freq(%)	Disagree Freq(%)	Mean
1	Rehabilitation programmes influences greater chances of change in recidivists	140	59(44%)	81(56%)	2.40
2	The exposure of recidivists to prison rehabilitation programmes makes them more productive and creative	140	44(29%)	96(71%)	2.43
3	Recidivist become more socially conscious of the negative impacts of crime and violence	140	84(65%)	56(44%)	3.71
4	Rehabilitation programmes helps recidivist to received better education which enhance positive thinking.	140	88(61%)	52(39%)	3.77
5	recidivists are less inclined to commit crime due to rehabilitation	140	70(50)	70(50%)	2.21
6	Rehabilitation programmes would able to change the mindset of recidivists to positive thinking.	140	65(55%)	75(45%)	2.33

Field survey, 2024

Table 2 revealed that showing the influence of rehabilitation programmes on prison recidivists. The table showed that 59 respondents (44%) agreed that rehabilitation programmes influence greater chances of change in recidivists while 81respondents (56%) disagreed. 44 respondents (29%) agreed that exposure of recidivists to prison rehabilitation programmes makes them more productive and creative while 96(71%) respondents disagreed. 88 respondents (61%) agreed that rehabilitation programmes help recidivist to receive better education which enhance positive thinking wile 52 respondents (39%) disagreed. 70 respondents (50%) agreed that recidivists are less inclined to commit crime due to rehabilitation while 70 respondents (50%) disagreed with the assertion. 140 respondents (65%) agreed that rehabilitation programmes would able to change the mindset of recidivists to positive thinking while 75 respondents (45%) disagreed.

Hypothesis 1: There is no significant difference in the mean score of male and female recidivists on the influence of rehabilitation programme in Ondo State.?

In testing the hypothesis, score of recidivists to the questionnaire items on the influence of rehabilitation programme on the basis of gender were scored, computed and subjected to statistical tools involving t-test analysis. The result is presented in Table 3

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Table 3: T-test Statistical Analysis of Male and Female Recidivist on the Influence of Rehabilitation Programme

Gender	N	X	SD	Df	t-cal	t-cri	Rem
Male	101	86.88	8.398				
				138	0.569	1.787	Sig P<0.05
Female	39	86.78	7.232				

Field survey, 2024

Table 3 showed that there was no significant different on the influence of rehabilitation programme between male and female recidivist in correctional centers, with t-cal of 0.569 less than t-cri of 1.787 at 0.05 level of significance. This implies that the null hypothesis which stated that there was no significant difference on the rehabilitation programme between male and female recidivist was not rejected.

Hypothesis 2: There is no significant difference in the mean score of recidivists on the influence of rehabilitation programme on the basis of age in Ondo State.

In testing the hypothesis, score of recidivists to the questionnaire items on the influence of rehabilitation programme on the basis of age were scored, computed and subjected to statistical tools involving Anova. The result is presented in Table 4.

Table 4: Table 14: ANOVA summary showing the influence of rehabilitation services on age group

	Sum of Squares	df	Mean Square	F	Sig.
Between Groups	3371.489	3	1123.830	.415	.661
Within Groups	1483.471	136	10.161		
Total	4854.960	139			

Field survey, 2024

The ANOVA result on Table 4 indicated that the computed F- value (.415) with degrees of freedom 3 and 136 was significant at p> 0.05 level of significance for the groups since the P value of is greater than the level of significance (P =0.05). Therefore, the hypothesis was not rejected. This implies that rehabilitation programme had no significant difference on the age group of recidivists in Ondo State.

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Discussion of Findings

This study reveals that the rehabilitation programmes of recidivists in Ondo State correctional center, Nigeria, as indicated by the research respondents include social intervention, skills acquisition, educational and recreational services. The findings of this study is in agreement with the finding of Omorogiuwa & Igbinovia (2019) that found prisons reformation and rehabilitation of inmates can be actualized through programmes such as: social case and group work/intervention, recreational activities, educational and skills acquisition programmes (Nigeria Prison Service, 1989). This study investigated influence of rehabilitation programmes on socio-demographic characteristics of recidivism in Ondo State. The result contained in Table 2 shown that respondents indicated that rehabilitation programme would be able to influence recidivists to have a positive thinking through education and services available in the correctional centers, if properly enhance in the yard while serving their jail term. The finding was in line with the assertion of Awopetu (2014) who observed that rehabilitation programmes help to give former offenders the opportunity to work, providing income and meaning in their lives. Some provide mentorship, housing placement, workforce development, and employment placement among other supportive services. There is no better way to help prison inmates avoid breaking in and out of jail cycle and functioning suitably in the society on release, than assisting them acquire the skills needed to succeed in later life through rehabilitation (Uche, Uche, Ezumah, Ebue, Okafor & Ezegbe, 2015). Prison is an institution designed to securely house people who have been convicted of crimes or are on awaiting trial.

The finding also indicated that there is no significant difference on rehabilitation programmes based on gender. It revealed that both male and female would yield positively to rehabilitation programmes that are available in the correctional centers in Ondo State. This finding disagreed with the assertion of Omorogiuwa &Egoh (2021) who submitted that rehabilitation programmes on female inmates were not very successful due to lack of fund, inadequacy of rehabilitation equipment, lack of trained personnel and lack of manpower and poor management of rehabilitation programmes among others. The result of the finding also indicated that there is no significant difference in on the rehabilitation programmes based on age group in the correctional centres of Ondo State. The finding is supportive of Omorogiuwa & Igbinovia (2019) who confirmed that prison rehabilitation programme can influence all age group in the society. This implies that the there is need for improvement in correctional services toward proper rehabilitation of the recidivists for preparing the inmates for life after incarceration.

Conclusion

Given that the rehabilitation of offenders can be achieved through carefully designed and well- articulated reformative and rehabilitative programmes, this current research attempts to investigate the influence of rehabilitation programmes on socio-demographic of recidivists in Ondo State. Given the findings of the study, it is ascertained that the rehabilitation programmes including skill acquisition, educational services, recreational activities and social interventional services were observed in the correctional centers in Ondo State. It was also concluded that rehabilitation programme would help recidivists to change their mindset to positive thinking which would lead to declination to commit more crime. Moreover, few of the inmates acknowledged that the rehabilitation services they received influenced them positively, given

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their changed attitudes and the skills learned for personal and social development. It may possibly be established that recidivist is likely to function positively on release in the society as a result of the effectiveness of the rehabilitation services received in the prison, which enhances their well-being. Therefore, the results of this study provide momentous evidence in support of the need to improve prison rehabilitation programmes in order to enhance their successful restoration and reintegration into the society.

Recommendations

Based on the aforementioned findings, recommendations are made that:

1. Correctional centers should be sufficiently funded by the Government to boost effective rehabilitation of inmates.
2. Additional skills acquisition programmes such as computer trainings, auto-mechanics, photography, barbing and hair-dressing are established to boost inmates' employment opportunities on discharge from the prisons.
3. There is need for provision of more recreational activities in the prisons by the Government, since inmates preferred one recreational activity to the other.
4. There is need for employment of more helping professionals such as social workers, to improve the social intervention services rendered to inmates in the prisons.

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